ISSUE No.18 MAY 1996

Thamesmead TIMES

The Front Page

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WIN *A TRIP TO EURO-DISNEY WITH LEWIS GROUP TRAVEL.* *FULL DETAILS PAGE 9*

WIN *FREE TICKETS TO THE BIGGIN HILL AIR SHOW.* *FULL DETAILS PAGE 5*



Thamesmead Cycle Route now open – Full story on page 5



Staff at the newly opened Thamesmead Carpets Superstore can be seen celebrating their Grand Opening with Champagne and apple juice.
For the full story see page 3

APOLOGY FROM THE EDITOR:

I would like to apologise profusely for the problems that occurred during the delivery of the April issue - and especially to those readers who did not get the opportunity to enter the Chipperfields competition - I do hope that you will have lots of opportunities throughout the year to enter our other promotions. THE WINNERS OF THE CHIPPERFIELDS COMPETITION WERE TRACY PRICE, MRS HOMEWOOD, JUDITH PHILIPS, MARY APPIAH, WILMA CASSEIL, NITAL NTOBI.

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RTM are looking for the top "Local Pub" why not make it yours! See Page 8

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Unit 4, Kencot Way, Thamesmead DA18 4AB.

NEWS FROM THE BOROUGHS

GREENWICH
People and Services First

Walk-about Talk-about Greenwich Greenwich Leisure Services, Bexley and Greenwich Health Promotion and the Greenwich Tour Guides Association are working together to develop a programme of walks especially targeted to the over 50's as part of the Health Education Authority's "Active for Life" campaign. Anyone who wants to be more physically active whilst uncovering places of local interest can pick up a brochure with details from libraries, community centres, leisure centres, doctor's surgeries and most over 50's organisations. Cost per walk is £1.00 which is payable to the guide on the day. For details contact Steve Johnson on 0181 312 5670

Have you paid your council tax? The council tax for 1996/7 is payable by monthly installments starting in April, but it has been noticed that many people are overlooking payment of their first installments. Failing to pay the first two monthly installments on time can mean losing the right to pay by installments all together. This would mean paying any remaining council tax in full immediately. Anyone experiencing difficulties paying council tax should contact the Council Tax office on 0181 312 5276 or 0181 312 5277.

Council officers uncover fake spirits Trading Standards Officers visiting pubs in the borough have discovered that some publicans are offering spirits for sale that are not the real thing and that some bottles bearing well known brands had been filled with cheaper brands. This is an offense under the Trades Description Act 1968 and carries a maximum fine of £5,000 and/or 6 months imprisonment. Further visits will be made throughout the borough in the next couple of months.

Best in the Borough for Training The Building Cleaning Division has scored yet another first for the Borough and been awarded the prestigious Investors in People certificate for commitment to training.

St Nicholas Ward election results Alistair MacRae was elected as Councillor for St. Nicholas ward with a majority of over 600. The election was held on May 2nd.

Greenwich Sport A new sports network has been set up for voluntary clubs, groups, organisations or individuals. Supported by Greenwich Leisure Services, the group is for all people involved in sport within the borough and is free to join. Members will receive a regular newsletter and be included in the new Greenwich Sports Directory. Call Jeff Davis on 0181 312 5670 if interested and wish to attend the inaugural meeting on Tuesday, 28th May.

Bexley
LONDON BOROUGH

Health merger The Family Health Service Authority is to combine with the old Bexley and Greenwich Health to become the new Bexley and Greenwich Health Authority and is one of a network of 100 new authorities across the country. Public board meetings will alternate between Bexley & Greenwich. The new telephone number is 0181 298 6000.

Bexley reduces vehicle emissions Bexley has unveiled plans to ensure the vehicles that it uses to clean the streets also help to cut pollution by insisting that all vehicles produce half the emissions of conventional diesel vehicles. All contractors will be required to submit details of other low emission options. The council will inspect all their vehicles and equipment at regular intervals.

Elderly to benefit from grant Sheltered accommodation residents in Bexley will soon be able to benefit from a range of courses, including craft and gentle exerciser funded by the Bexley Trust for Adult Students. This has been made possible by a £12,000 grant from the Bridge House Estates Trust. Staff from the Adult Education College for Bexley will work with the trust to set up the project. Contact Barbara Ferguson 0181309 9094

PLEASE NOTE YOUR NEW THAMESMEAD HOUSING CONTACTS

AREA TEAM 1
Covering Areas 1 and 2
(Paired with Team 4)

Housing Manager:
Toni Martin (Ext 341)
Housing Officers:
Sue Sullivan (Ext 224)
+ 1 ANO (000)
Housing Assistant:
Chris Philibosie (Ext 434)
Surveyor:
Mehmet Bekir (Ext 439)
Warden:
Ann Turner

Constituency Areas:
BROADWATERS & WATERFIELD

AREA TEAM 2
Covering Area 3
(Paired with Team 3)

Housing Manager:
Jackie Andrews (Ext 438)
Housing Officers:
Zena Lee (Ext 281)
Gillian Lightfoot (Ext 375)
Housing Assistant:
Kay Ashmore (Ext 328)
Surveyor:
Clive Bentley (Ext 254)
Wardens:
Pat Beardsley
Ann Turner

Constituency Areas:
MOORINGS

AREA TEAM 3
Covering Areas 4, 5 & 9
(Paired with Team 2)

Housing Manager:
Karen Williams (Ext 214)
Housing Officers:
Paula Panzavechia (Ext 212)
Adnan Chaudhry (Ext 356)
Housing Assistant:
June Field (Ext 268)
Surveyor:
David Lee (Ext 238)
Wardens:
Vi Perfitt, Angela Casey
Sue Murray

Constituency Areas:
MANORWAY, CROSSWAY & GREENMEAD

AREA TEAM 4
Covering Area 6
(Paired with Team 1)

Housing Manager:
Ruth Kinniburgh (Ext 277)
Housing Officers:
James Edwards (Ext 202)
Yvonne Husseyin (Ext 204)
Housing Assistant:

AREA TEAM 5
Covering Area 7
(Paired with Team 6)

Housing Manager:
Pamela Martin (Ext 324)
Housing Officers:
Lynn Ashdown (Ext 442)
+ 1 ANO (Ext 000)
Housing Assistant:

AREA TEAM 6
Covering Area 8
(Paired with Team 5)

Housing Manager:
Vivien Lyons (Ext 403)
Housing Officers:
Catherine Riva (Ext 205)
Nazarene Active (Ext 427)
Housing Assistant:

IMPO FOR R

Tham arran meeting dents c 1996 Her Whincho West. Th from reside exhib Broadwat will be av bef The Comp opportu raise gene Broadwa to infor improve your area a whole. you wish please

Information from Waterways

VOLUNTEER COMMITTEE MEMBERS WANTED

Waterways Community Childrens Centre are looking for active, volunteer committee members for management of the children's nursery. Commitment of one evening per month is required.

BOOT FAIR

Waterways are fundraising for improvements to their building and equipment for the children and are holding a Boot Fair to help with this.The boot fair is on Sunday 28th July in Birchmere Park, Thamesmead from 8am to 2pm.

Call Jill Turner for futher information if you are interested in taking a pitch. For information about being a Committee Member or the Boot Fair please call Jill on 0181 311 5491

Rose is 100!



Rose Bullivant celebrated her 100th birthday on the 18th April at Gallions View Nursing Home, Thamesmead.

Staff and Hobby Therapists from Hutton House organised the celebration which was attended by the Pearly King and Queen from Woolwich.

Rose received a telegram from the Queen and lots of flowers.



Rose flankd by the Pearly King and Queen

THAMESMEAD'S NEW CARPET SUPERSTORE IS OPEN FOR BUSINESS



It's seldom that you find a local shop thriving in this day and age. All our consumer needs can be fulfilled at one massive multi-superstore and our local high street businesses have definitely felt the pinch from their success.

This certainly is not the case for the new Thamesmead Carpet Superstore which has just expanded into larger premises opposite Safeways in Thamesmead's town centre.

The manager of the Superstore, Tom, has realised that there is a gap in the market for floor coverings in the Thamesmead area. This comes as little surprise when you consider the amount of house building that goes on here.

"I used to work in a carpet shop in Woolwich during the Eighties, loads of our custom came from people living in Thamesmead".

Tom has worked in the carpet business for sixteen years and knows everything from selling to fitting. This, he says, is why he can offer his customers an excellent service and peace of mind as they can be assured that they are in reliable hands.

"I even know all the measurements to all the flats and houses in Thamesmead. Customers don't have to worry about all those kinds of things because I know the job inside-out. All they have to do is simply choose what carpet they like".

The customer is the most important part of this business. The manager is proud of its good reputation and guarantees that each customer can depend on them to deliver on time and fit the carpets with no fuss and bother. Tom is determined to maintain the Thamesmead Carpets excellent service, but now in the bigger and better Thamesmead Carpet Superstore.

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½ PRICE ROOM SIZE REMNANTS
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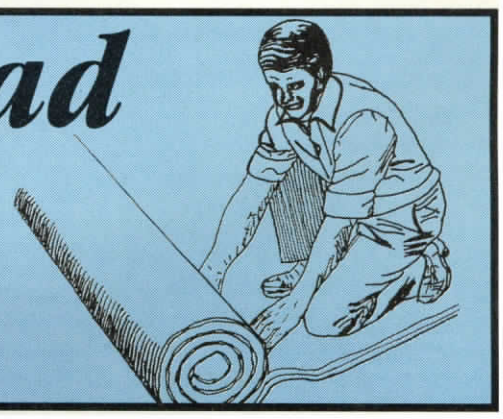
AS YOUR LOCAL SHOP WE KNOW MOST OF YOUR SIZES.
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FREE
LOCAL DELIVERIES ON ORDERS OVER £35.00

EXPERT FITTING BY OUR OWN CARPET FITTERS
ONE YEAR GUARANTEE ON ALL OUR FITTING

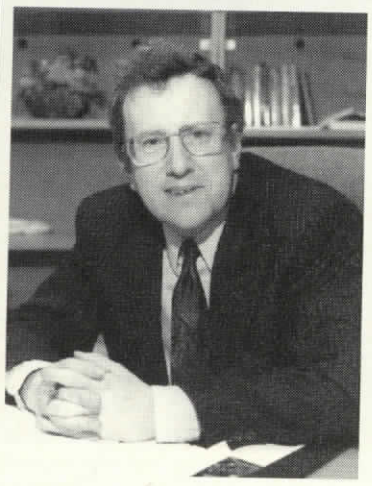
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Thamesmead Carpets Superstore



Thamesmead

COMMENT



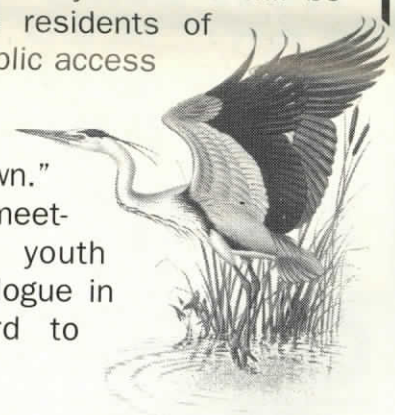
On behalf of the Board let me welcome Mr. Tony Cotter who has taken over from Housing Consultant Geoff Mitchell as Housing Services Director, we are confident that he will make a valuable contribution to the improvement and continued development of the services that the Housing team offer. We will, of course be sorry to see Geoff go but thank him for his commitment to Thamesmead during his time with us and wish him much luck for the future

This month, following an invitation from Thamesmead Mr. Stephen Norris, Minister of Transport formally opened the first section of the Thames Cycle Route which runs along the River Thames adjacent to Riverside Golf Club.

In partnership with London Borough of Bexley and Sustrans, Chairman Peter Mountfield with myself, Dave Irons and Albert Devereux were pleased to join with officers, councillors and MPs from Greenwich, Bexley and Kingston in the inauguration.

The issue of Sustainable transport is very high on the social and political agenda at present and Thamesmead are delighted to be involved in providing a safe and pleasant area for cyclists to use, as Peter Mountfield commented "The completion of the first section of the Thames Cycle route will be greatly welcomed by the residents of Thamesmead, it allows public access to a further 1 km to the 1.5 km of riverside already accessible in the town."

I am encouraged to see meetings with Thamesmead youth evolving from our first dialogue in March and look forward to seeing the results.



New Housing Services Director

THAMESMEAD would like to welcome Tony Cotter as our new Housing Services Director. He joined the company on 7th May.

After some 15 years experience in housing, culminating in the position of Chief Housing Officer at Tunbridge Wells, he joined Coopers & Lybrand management Consultants as Senior Associate in 1990, with responsibility as Head of Housing Practice for the South East, providing support and advice to client housing authorities and associations.



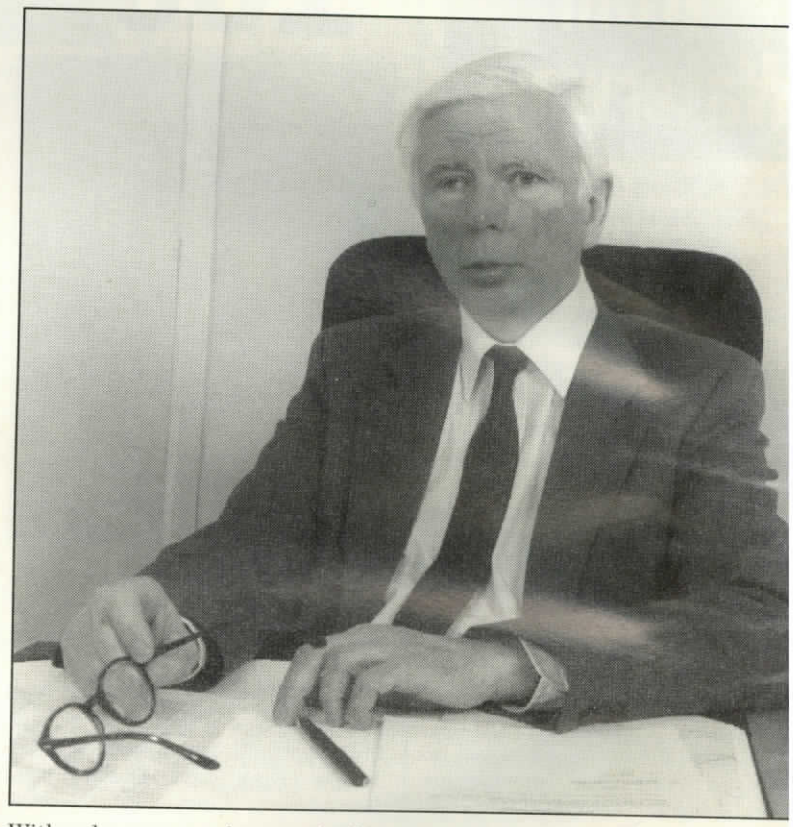
New housing Director Tony Cotter

Being new to the Thamesmead area Mr Cotter admits that before he came to this job he held an ill informed view of Thamesmead thinking it was merely a mass of concrete tower blocks.

"Having had a good look around it's overwhelmingly obvious that Thamesmead simply isn't like that. There's a great deal of good housing here and the place itself has huge potential." He is most looking forward to developing an excellent working relationship between the housing department and the tenants of Thamesmead.

Peter Mountfield is the new chair of the board of directors of Thamesmead Town

Rosalind Bayley talks to Thamesmead's new leader



What makes a high flying civil servant and one of the top players in the World Bank want to come to Thamesmead? In Peter Mountfield's case, it was an interest in the place that stretches back for 30 years. In the 1960s he had visited the fledgling town, as he was inspired by the idea of creating a new community from scratch, and went himself to live at New Ash Green, a private estate near Sevenoaks that has a lot in common with Thamesmead.

So when he saw the job advertised in December, it clicked. 'It occurred to me that it was a splendid opportunity to come and do something useful here.'

Common Problems

Before coming for the interview for the job, he did a bit of reconnaissance and found a lot had changed since his last visit. And what was his verdict? 'Generally it is a very good place though there are serious problems, particularly with the system built flats. The thing that struck me in particular was the lack of adequate facilities for children and young people, and the distance from the shops. It is not an easy place to get around, particularly for young mothers.'

How relevant was living in New Ash Green to Thamesmead? 'Like in Thamesmead, only a limited number of people were willing to take part in running the community, which puts a great strain on the active members,' he says. Because the houses in New Ash Green were privately owned, or housing association, the residents did not have to be landlords. But many of the issues that had to be dealt with were the same – dogs, children, community facilities, shops, arguments with the local bus companies, maintaining the common land.

Finance Background

What are the other skills he brings to Thamesmead? 'I am basically a civil servant,' he says. He started in the Treasury and spent most of his career there, working first on public expenditure control and then on third world debt. And then, finally, there were four years with the World Bank in Washington. He believes this has prepared him well to work with the board of directors of Thamesmead Town and to develop policy for Thamesmead.

'Negotiating is certainly one of my skills. Any reasonable civil servant has experience of running meetings, organising committees, making sure the right questions get asked, checking that things get done - and trying to establish a consensus when a lot of people don't agree on what they want to do.'

But he sees that as only one aspect of the job. 'Another part is trying to develop a long-term vision for Thamesmead, what it should look like in 20 or 30 years' time.' Part of this task is the sensitive business of looking at how the company is organised and considering whether improvements could be made.

'Because you have a majority of residents' representatives on the board, it is almost inevitable that they will concentrate on the immediate short term interests of residents and have less time to spare for the long-term needs of the community.' For the elected directors, it is a 'tight rope walk', trying to fulfil their responsibilities to their residents and and to think long-term.

Funding and development

Obviously development will be crucial to the long-term plan. Just into the job, he had the satisfaction of having the Safeway deal signed, which he describes as 'an enormous coup for the management team'. With a large area of car park, this should become a magnet for people from outside Thamesmead and draw in other shops and leisure facilities to the town centre. He is also very excited about the new urban village at Gallions Reach in on the western side of Thamesmead.

Another big challenge is the millennium project. The objective 'will be to make sure that it is not just a temporary phenomenon, to secure some long-term benefit from it'. Given Thamesmead's unique amount of open land, a likely contender is for a 'park and sail scheme' a variant of park and ride where people would drive to Thamesmead and then get a boat down to the millennium site on the Greenwich peninsula.

Plans for the future

While the long-term plans are fermenting slowly, Mr Mountfield is still getting to know Thamesmead. He is taking part in the rolling programme of reviewing the needs of each constituency area. In the five areas where public meetings have already been held, some consistent themes have been emerging - the needs of young people, the need to keep the young people away from the older people, dog nuisance, motor bike nuisance - and the need for a bit of greenery to relieve the very stark impression that parts of the town create.

So what are the chances of a sighting of the new chairman around Thamesmead? At the moment he is going walkabout with each of the elected directors. He is keen to meet people involved in community activities - and was most impressed by his first visit, to the Age Concern luncheon club - and is angling for invitations to to constituency meetings .

The right invitation could tempt his wife Margaret as well. She used to be a teacher, including a spell at St Patrick's school in Plumstead, and is interested in visiting Thamesmead's schools, though she now works as a painter. As for his three sons, one is a management consultant in Switzerland, one a social worker in Kent and the third a computer engineer living up in London. Between them, he has three grandchildren.

'As we were a good civil service family, the children are in triplicate.

And the future?.His contract with Thamesmead is for three years. Beyond that, he is not saying -but then that's civil service discretion.

New computer system for Thamesmead rents

A new computer system has bee installed for the Housin Department so all property refer ence numbers have now bee changed and new rent books hav been issued.

DON'T WORRY

Don't worry though if you have paid on your old rent book because it will automatically be transferred to the new account.

ARSON ATTACK ON RIVERSIDE RIDING CLUB

Members of the Riverside Riding Club are appalled by the arson attack made on their clubhouse early in the morning on Monday 29 April.

The clubhouse was broken into and set ablaze at about 5 a.m. Hundreds of pounds of riding equipment which was laid out in preparation for a riding show the next day was destroyed. A toilet designed especially for the disabled which stands next to the clubhouse was also damaged and will cost £13, 500 to replace.

The feeling at the club, which provides a great service to the community, particularly for young people, is that of deep disappointment and anger.

"It doesn't give us a chance," said John Masters, leader of the Riverside Riding Club,"we're very vulnerable here to people breaking in and have done all we can to stop it, but at the end of the day we're just easy pickings."

The club house was wired up to a security alarm which was set the night before. Mr Masters believes that whoever broke in must have known the code because the alarm was not activated.

The horses which are housed a few hundred yards from the clubhouse displayed visible signs of distress when the club leader reached the site a few hours after the fire was started.

Thamesmead Police are appealing to anyone who knows anything about this incident to come forward. Please call: 01813121212.

Are you **noise** conscious?

At the recent Moorings constituency meeting residents expressed their concern regarding the subject of noise - which, if you read the national newspapers or watch the television seems to be a problem that many people are unfortunately experiencing.

Following the meeting a survey was carried out of Beveridge Court, Lansbury Court and Hammond Way and the results were interesting:

80% of tenants complained of 'Noise'

This was broken down to:

Very Disturbing	36%
Disturbing	30%
Average	10%
Not too bad	2%
Hardly Hear any	2%

The causes of the noise complained of is broken down in order of complaint:

Hammering and drilling at all hours Playing loud music. Late night parties, Dogs barking at all hours of the day and night, Car Alarms sounding at all hours and Family rows.

Other things complained of were:

- Children playing noisily- ice cream vans - motorcycles.

Two additional questions were also asked of the residents:

- 36% of replies were in favour of forming a Neighbourhood Watch Committee.
- 26% were interested in joining in social events organised by neighbours.

Noise can severely affect quality of life and certainly can cause unnecessary disputes between neighbours so its up to all of us to just be more mindful of others and take a 'good neighbours' attitude where we live, merely understanding how noise can travel will make you more aware of its effects.

It's true to say that the nature of flats themselves can cause noise to travel round a block, even an open window will make sure everyone hears your music!

Thinking of others is at the heart of being 'Good Neighbours' and we all know that Thamesmead residents have a great community spirit.

Minister opens new Thames cycle route



The Minister for Transport for London, Steven Norris got on his bike on 7th May when he opened the first section of the new Thames Cycle Route. Twenty young cyclists from Castilion Primary School were also on hand to help at this event on the bank of the River Thames near the Riverside Golf Club, Crossways. Sustrans, the civil engineering charity (whose representatives cycled to the opening) introduced the idea of a Thames cycle route two years ago. With the assistance, primarily of Thamesmead and also Bexley London Borough the dream is beginning to take shape.

When completed the Thames Cycle Route, which forms part of the National Cycle Network, will run parallel to the Thames from Dartford to Hampton Court providing 44 miles of path which can also be enjoyed by walkers and people in wheelchairs.

This cycle route, like many others being set up around the country, is designed to to make riding a bike safer by being away from traffic and more attractive to the novice cyclists. Particular emphasis is being placed on getting people out of their cars for journeys under 5 miles long; cycle paths like this are ideal for such purposes.

"If you're going to get a lot more people cycling the overwhelming number of journeys that we do under five miles you've got to make them safer and give them facilities to the bike," said Mr Norris in his inauguration speech.

Local MP for Crayford and Erith constituency, David Evenett added,"We need to get the message across to local families that there is a facility here by our own River Thames which is wonderful! We should use, and it's fun!"

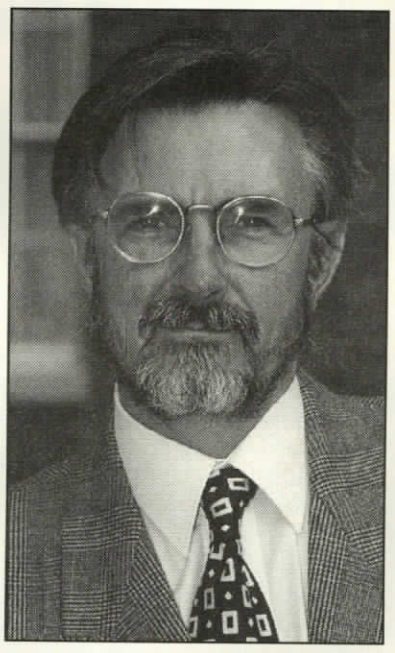
Funding for the Thamesmead section has come mainly from the Transport Policy Programmes joint bid for the London Cycle Network with Thamesmead Town and the Environment Agency (formerly the National Rivers Authority) contributing. The millennium fund has also contributed to the funding of this London cycle route and others nationwide considerably. It's hoped that by the year 2000 all London peddle pushers will be able to enjoy the scenic and historic pleasures to be seen from the banks of the River Thames without fear of articulated lorries and exhaust fumes.

THANK YOU!

Thamesmead would like to thank Terry Matthias of Wheelies cycle and equipment shop for loaning a bicycle to London Transport Minister, Steven Norris MP, to ride around the newly opened section of the Thames Cycle Route which runs alongside the river at Summerton Way, Thamesmead.
Mr. Norris was delighted with both the cycle he was given to ride and the cycle route itself.

Wheelies can be found at 239 Bexley Road, Erith. Telephone 01322 338625.

MP thanks London Marathon sponsors



Woolwich MP, John Austin-Walker, has expressed his grateful thanks to all those local companies and the many individuals who sponsored him in the London Marathon. Local companies and organisations giving their support included:

Emafyl (Robobond Ltd)
Barclays Bank (Woolwich)
Tunnel Refineries Ltd
Cray Pharmacy Ltd
Greenwich Distillers Ltd
Paul and Christine Manning
Lewis Gray & Son
Richard Edward Printing
The Old Mill Public House
Promotional Mailing Services Ltd
Thamesmead Town
Woolwich Building Society
Hunter Plastics Ltd
The Woodman Public House, Charlton
Morco (Tarpaulins & Blinds) Ltd
Negus 6th Form Centre
Metropolitan Electrical Services Ltd
Alltype Roofing Company
Capital Drawing Offices Ltd
Mellins Wine Bar
Erith & Thamesmead Labour Party

To date, John has raised over £2,500, £1,500 of which will go to the National Asthma Campaign and the remainder to be shared between:

Churchfield School
Maze Hill School
Halstow School
Charlton Park School
Annandale School
BADAIR
Greenacres Language Unit
Hawksmoor School (for the Greenwich & Bexley Cottage Hospice)
Thomas Tallis School (for the Royal Marsden Hospital for Cancer Research)

But there is more to come. The above schools were also raising sponsorship, half to go to the Asthma Campaign and half to their chosen project.

John Austin-Walker hopes to announce the final total before the Spring Bank Holiday.

BIGGIN HILL AIR FAIR COMPETITION



"The War That Never Was" will be commemorated at the Biggin Hill International Air Fair, Kent on June 15th & 16th - an unforgettable day out for the whole family.

Air Displays International and the Thamesmead Times have joined together to offer readers the chance to win a superb day out at the Air Fair. There are fifteen pairs of entry tickets on offer and all you have to do is answer three simple questions.

Having played a vital role in both world wars, the former Battle of Britain fighter station prepared itself for action again between 1951 and 1958 in response to the Soviet threat. Fighter planes were on stand by, waiting for a Russian attack that fortunately never came.

The highlight of a spectacular six hour display of flying on each day in June will be a spectacular mock scramble of Hunters attacking against a MiG. Breath taking combat manoeuvers will demonstrate the power and versatility of these aircraft as they sweep the skies in a fantastic exhibition of precision flying.

Aircraft from the First World War right up to the hi-tech fighters and jets of today will participate in the Air Fair, now in its 34th year and a popular fixture on the summer events calendar.

On the ground there will be fair, craft marquees and a number of exhibitions including military vehicles. Gates open at 9am and the air display starts at midday, finishing at around 6pm.

Further information and tickets are available from the organisers on 01959 540959.

READERS QUESTIONS

1) During which years was Biggin Hill on stand by against a Russian attack?

2) How long will each flying display be on each day of the Air Fair?

3) Which aircraft will take part in the mock scramble?

All you have to do is answer the simple questions above and send your reply to the Reader Competition, Thamesmead Times, Harrow Manor Way, Thamesmead South, London SE2 9XH by Friday 7th June. The first fifteen correct answers to be drawn out of a hat will be receiving a free pair of tickets.

Evennett gets tough on NOISE bill

Mr. David Evennett MP, a long-term campaigner for action on noisy neighbours, has tabled amendments to the Noise Bill which is at present going through Parliament to force Local Councils to implement its provisions.

Mr. Evennett is a sponsor of the Noise Bill which has been presented to Parliament by Ealing North MP Harry Greenaway, and has served on the Committee stage of the measure. Its provisions include making neighbour noise a criminal offence, with on-the-spot fines, possible court action, and confiscation of noise-making equipment.

During the Committee stage, Mr. Evennett successfully proposed that the on-the-spot fine of £40 was increased to £100. However, while the Bill gives new powers to Local Councils, it allows them to decide whether they are going to adopt the provision in their area.

Mr. Evennett's new amendments would make implementation mandatory, at least in urban areas. "The Bill is a good one and will bring relief to long-term sufferers of noisy neighbours. However, if the measure is not implemented when on the statute book we will have wasted our time, and large numbers of the population particularly in urban areas - will be bitterly disappointed. The provision will be effective, but only, I believe, if the measure is mandatory and not optional for Local Authorities."

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£850.00 ono
Call 0181 316 0529

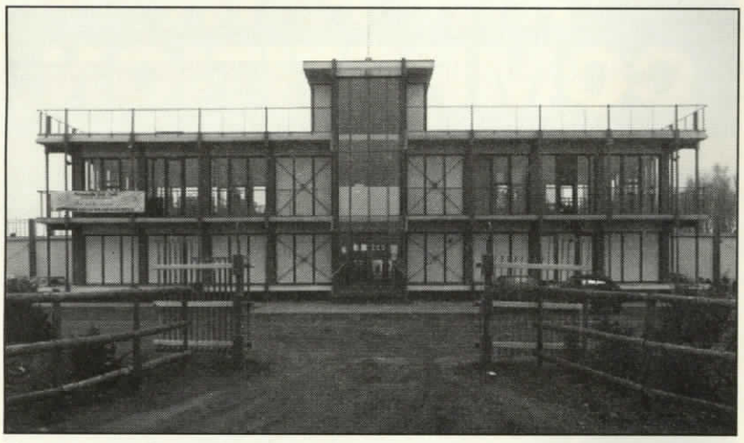
So–you think you're brave ?

Then take the Tenner Test!

Thamesmead Adventure Scheme is organising a sponsored ABSEIL from the top of Beveridge Court, Thamesmead on Sunday, June 2. All proceeds to the well-known Thamesmead Adventure Scheme, so if you are brave, get sponsored for more than a Tenner! Turn up from 10 o'clock onwards and we'll sling you off the top!

For further details, contact Rick at the nick

RIVERSIDE GOLF CLUB: PUTTING IT NICELY!



For many people joining a golf club is financially out-of-reach. Indeed, the leisurely pursuit of this sport can be a costly activity: the clubs, the shoes and not forgetting, of course, the membership fees - it adds up to a hefty sum.

Well, that's usually the case but at Thamesmead's Riverside Golf Club you don't have to earn the salary of Nick Faldo to put a hole in one! Eddie Springham, the Managing Director of the club is confident that two hundred and fifty pounds for unlimited golf all year round is a bargain that can't be found at any other golf club near the Thamesmead area.

Situated just off Summerton Way near Crossness, the Riverside Golf Club resides on the banks of the River Thames. Its most attractive feature is the Club House which stands splendidly by the rolling terrane of the nine hole golfing course. Amazingly, the building designed by David Heffer, (the architect for other buildings in Thamesmead) was constructed within twenty-six days. This is amazing when you consider the facilities it has on board. The club house boasts a beautifully spacious function room and restaurant which is free to use if you are a member; a bar where you can enjoy a game of pool or darts after a round of golf; a shop which stocks all your golfing needs.

The Riverside Golf Club opened to the public in October of 1992 by the then Thamesmead Town Chief Executive, Philip Glascoe. It was the idea of Eddie Springham and supported by his partners John Fuller, Gordon More of JPMP Developments

"I wanted to set the golf club up so there'd be a bit more variety for the people in Thamesmead in terms of sport", said Mr. Springham. There is also local dimension to Eddie's sporting ethos, "The only way you're going to attract more Thamesmead people to playing golf, or any sport for that matter, is if admission fees are set at an affordable price".

Eddie Springham is a local businessman. He's the Managing Director of the very successful company Casemore Engineering based in Thamesmead employing approximately 130 people, many of whom live locally. He's also a family man and all of his immediate family works for at the Golf Club. Sara-Jane, aged 26, and trained as a legal secretary is at the helm of running the golf club.

Besides being committed to providing good golfing for Thamesmead, the members at Riverside Golf Course is also collectively concerned with community affairs. A prime example of this is their charity appeal for 1996 to raise money for a Blood Gas Analyzer for Greenwich Hospital. A whole weekend in April was devoted to collecting the much needed cash.

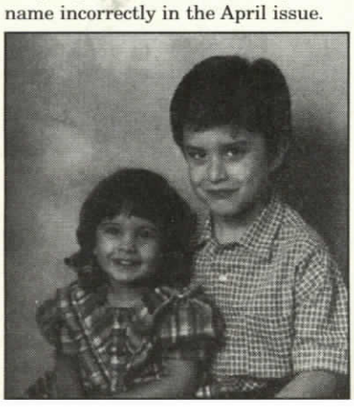
Closer to the Golf Club's home Eddie Springham also tries to help the youth of Thamesmead. Mr. Springham believes that the reason why many youths get into trouble with the law is because there are few after school activities, particularly sport, that are financial accessible to youngsters. To help remedy this problem Mr. Springham has set up a golfing Youth League consisting of ten teenagers. "At first the kids would just muck around but we taught them how to play golf but now they've learnt the sport and are progressing really well".

There is definitely more to Riverside Golf Club than tees and Pringle jumpers. If you want to find out more about the club call 0181 310 7975.

RAVI PALANISAMY

Ravi, who with his sister Rianna, were the winners of the family section of the Thamesmead Shopping Centre Photographic competition obviously has talent as well as looks! Ravi recently entered the Blackheath Music Festival and won his section which was the 6 years and under Piano Solo, playing two pieces of work. Well done Ravi!

We would like to take this opportunity to apologise too though as we spelt his name incorrectly in the April issue.



Cross Channel tra meet on Thamesm

A delegation of French business men and women met their English contemporaries at the head offices of Thamesmead most successful company, Europa, on l9th April.

In the presence of the Mayor of Bexley, Cllr. Colin Wright, the six strong deputation came Bexley's French twin town, Evry which is a south east suburb of Paris. The group of representatives contained people from a variety of fields from business consultants to careers advisors dealing with retraining the unemployed.

Bexley has already been to Evry with the objective of learning new ways to boost the local economy. It was now the turn of our French cousins to come here and gain an informative insight into the methods the London Borough of Bexley and Greenwich are using to enhance business opportunities and employment in the area.

Maggie Compton of the Bexley and Greenwich Chamber of Commerce said, " The links we have with Evry are invaluable. France is facing similar economic problems



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Not only has t learning exercis also an excellent strong business

NURSERY T WEST THAMESM

Parents who work at the West Thamesmead Business Park will be pleased to learn that they are to given the unique option of new child care facilities from this June. The company responsible for this development is the Nathan Way based company, Hi-Lo who manufacture warehouse storage equipment. The aim is to provide forty places to children from the ages of ought to four years old.

Parents who work for Hi-Lo will be given first refusal to places although the option of this child-care facility will be open to all workers in and surrounding the business park area.

This non-profit making Nursery is planned to open mid-June and construction work will be substantially completed as this article goes to print. It will be ideally situated on the corner of Nathan Way making it easily accessible for parents to delivery and collect their children to and from work. Nathan Way Nursery (a working title at the moment) promises high quality child-care at a reasonable rate and will be open weekdays from 7a.m. until 6 p.m.

The whole development is expected to generate many other benefits than just that of excellent creche facilities. Director of Hi-Lo Manufacturers, David Robjohns is very excited by this new development, "This nursery will add greater vibrancy to the Business Park. Having the nursery will lift the whole feeling of the Business Park making it more attractive to both employees and future business interest".



Thamesmead To at a price w construction of Nathan Way poss

"We're very Thamesmead Woolwich Deve without them t remain as a Mr. Robjohns.

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SIERRA

A boost for youth a scholarship awards presentation

On 16th April Thamesmead Town demonstrated its commitment to Thamesmead's young people with the presentation of twenty of the new Youth Scholarship Awards, at the offices in Harrow Manor Way.

The scheme is the first of its kind in Thamesmead and an idea not yet adopted by other borough councils in the surrounding area. It offers Thamesmead children between the ages of ten and seventeen, respectively, free admission or free subscription for a full calendar year to any one of the participating clubs. Activities on offer range from dancing, karate, scouting and angling plus many more.

A hundred places paid for by Thamesmead Town were made available at the launch of the scheme at the end of March this year. Richard Chaplin, Community Officer for Thamesmead Town said, "This is an excellent idea which will no doubt prove to give local children and teenagers a positive boost. I hope that other boroughs will take our lead and set up similar schemes".

At the presentation, Dave Irons Vice Chairman of Thamesmead Town and elected Director for Waterfield outlined some of the benefits of the scheme.

"Some of the architecture of Thamesmead doesn't suit kids play - there are too many nooks and crannies making it difficult for parents to watch over them", Mr Dave Irons continued, "Kids minds need to be occupied and this scheme gives them the ideal opportunity to direct their energies instead of getting bored–it's then that kids get into trouble".



Happy winners

Many parents in Thamesmead are living on low incomes. However, with this scheme that cost can be alleviated. Glen Powell is a single dad looking after three daughters the two eldest Tara, 12 and Chantel, 10 have both won a scholarship each to the Freestyle Karate Club paying for a years subscription.

"We all enjoy Karate, me and my two eldest have been going to Freestyle for about a year. Now Tara and Chantel have free admission we can afford to pay for the youngest to go too", he continued, "Having a hobby like karate is good for my daughters because it gives them more confidence in themselves".

You can still apply

There are still places left! So if you are interested and want to find out about participating clubs in please contact the Community Department at the Thamesmead town offices on 0181310 1500. We would like to stress that the only requirement for acceptance is that children should be Thamesmead residents and aged between 10 and 17 respectively.



Young Vi journalist the year competiti

Videotron, London's larg operator has teamed Channel One to launch a tion to find the You Journalist of the Year. Ch is a 24 hour cable TV netw provides continuous new and local topical features.

The competition is secondary school chil Greater London who shou their written ideas for an i and informative news i successful entrant from e six London cable franch will be invited to Chann assist in the production of news items which will be to nearly half a million ho

The competition will by members of the Bette Campaign, including the n Trevor McDonald, a by Independent Te Commission's Cable & Director, Jon Davey.

The overall winner wil £1,000 worth of PC W vouchers for his or her own a £2,000 set of high qua production equipment f her school. This inclu camcorders, an edit record software and associated it

Entries are invit individuals and will be their newsworthy content their competent use of Channel One is looking f interest to a variety of which can be recorded qu a single camera. Details forms are available from schools. Good luck!

New Futures awar won by Thamesme Community Colleg

Thamesmead Community College have won a national award from Barclays Bank PLC under their 'New Futures' sponsorship.

The award, with a value of £3000, is designed to assist the college with new computer equipment and software which will allow the senior pupils to teach younger pupils as well as older members in the community with a range of PC skills that they otherwise would not have been able to acquire.



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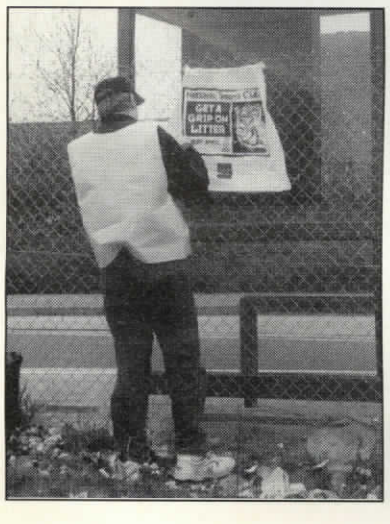
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NATIONAL SPRING CLEAN 'GET A GRIP ON LITTER'



The National Spring clean, which took place between the 12th and 21 April, was organised by Tidy Britain Group, it is the largest environmental clean-up in the UK, with millions of people all cleaning up their bit of the country every year.

In Thamesmead Mr. J. P. Ryan undertook to clean the Angling Club Ground in Thamesmere Drive near the Leisure Centre and also an area near the Harrow Canal in Joyce Dawson Close, ably assisted by his grandson Steven.

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GO TO EURO-DISNEY ON

le Shuttle with LEWIS GROUP TRAVEL

Saturday 27th – Sunday 28th July
and
Saturday 31st Aug – Sunday 1st Sept

PLUS THE CHANCE TO WIN TWO FREE TICKETS

Lewis Group Travel have offered another wonderful opportunity to the readers of the Thamesmead Times– the chance to win two free tickets for a trip to Euro-Disney on Le Shuttle plus brilliant price deals.

THE PRICE ONLY £69 FOR ADULTS £64 FOR CHILDREN
CAN YOU AFFORD NOT TO GO?

WHAT'S INCLUDED?

Luxury Coach Travel • Return Crossings on Le-Shuttle • Admission to Euro-Disney • Short Parisienne Sightseeing Tour • One Night Bed and Breakfast Accommodation • Twin rooms only are available.

A deposit of £25 per person is required, and insurance is available at just £6.50 per person.
Sorry, but there is a single room supplement.

WIN WIN WIN

THE FIRST TWO PEOPLE TO BOOK WILL GET THEIR TRIPS ABSOLUTELY FREE!

The booking office is open 9.00am to 6.00pm Monday to Friday and 9.00am to 1.00pm Saturday
Telephone 0181 858 0031.

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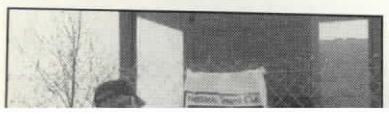
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Luxury Coach Travel • Return Crossings on L
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WIN WIN WI

FIRST YOUTH CONSULTATION

THE FIRST THAMESMEAD YOUTH CONSULTATION MEETING WAS HELD AT THE JUBILEE CENTRE ON THURSDAY 25TH APRIL ORIGINATING FROM THE YOUTH DIALOGUE WITH THAMESMEAD IN MARCH.

Twenty nine young people attended the meeting and showed lots of enthusiasm in the sports equipment that was being offered for the the site adjacent to the Titmuss Avenue Police Station.

Following various discussions, the group selected what they saw as of most interest to them from the suggestions made by Thamesmead.

Toward the end of the meeting the group made their final choices by voting as follows:

Short Tennis	**20**
Basketball Goals	**20**
Seats and shelter	**18**
Five a side goals	**17**
Fitness equipment	**22**

The site layout was accepted by all 29.

It is hope to start on the site in the near future.





Green Fingers at the Jubilee schoo

The staff and pupils at the Jubilee School, Thamesmead took part in the National School Grounds Day on May 3rd. This nationwide event was held to raise awareness of the importance of school grounds and particularly the positive effects of being involved in the development and use of the landscape.

Along with thousands of other school children around the country, the pupils of the Jubilee School took part in events and activities which helped the young people to develop positive attitudes towards th environment.

Every child at the school too part in a full survey of what cou be found growing and living in th school grounds–special attentio was paid to the herb garden ar the pond area. The school al concentrated on the special role trees within the environment.

The day was hailed as a grea success and as can be seen from ou photo, fun was had by all thos involved as they learnt about th environment around them.



National early learning week

The Southgate Nursery, Yarnton Way, Thamesmead is taking part in National Early Learning Week which takes place between 17th and 21st June.

The early learning week is a national event which is organised by the British Association of Early Childhood Education who will be organising events on a countrywide scale.

Southgate Nursery will be holding its own events which will include an open day to be held on Thursday 20th June - the nursery staff will be opening the doors to parents, governors, local councillors and anyone else who is interested in the nursery and its vital role in the local community. On Friday 21st June a Fun Day will be held and the children will take part in sponsored events. Anyone interested should contact Jill Crowley on 0181 310 0695.

Acorn Playgroup One O'Clock Club

A 10th Fun Day will be held at Glimpsing Green One O'Clock Club, near Northwood Primary School, on Wednesday, 29th May from 10.00am until noon. Various attractions include refreshments, raffle, cake stall, tombola, nearly-new clothes, bric-a-brac, face painting etc to raise funds for the under 5's Playgroup Trip to Godstone Farm.

If you wish to sell your own goods book a table for £5 by telephoning the Club.

There are now places available for the Acorn Playgroup, please telephone 0181-310-1500 extension 451 for more information.

Drop in workshop

The community carpenters invite you to their annual open days to be held on Tuesday, 11 June and Wednesday, 12 June between ll.OOam and 3.00pm both days at 17/18 Chalmers House, Europa Trading Estate, Fraser Road, Erith.

The Drop-In Workshop is a carpentry workshop that makes toys and play equipment for any organisation involved with children. All the people working at the Drop-In are volunteers.

The volunteers will be demonstrating their skills on both days and a range of goods will be on display.

Children are most welcome - Refreshments will be provided.

CABOUCHON

As seen on Channel 4
Are you interested in

FASHION ACCESSORIES

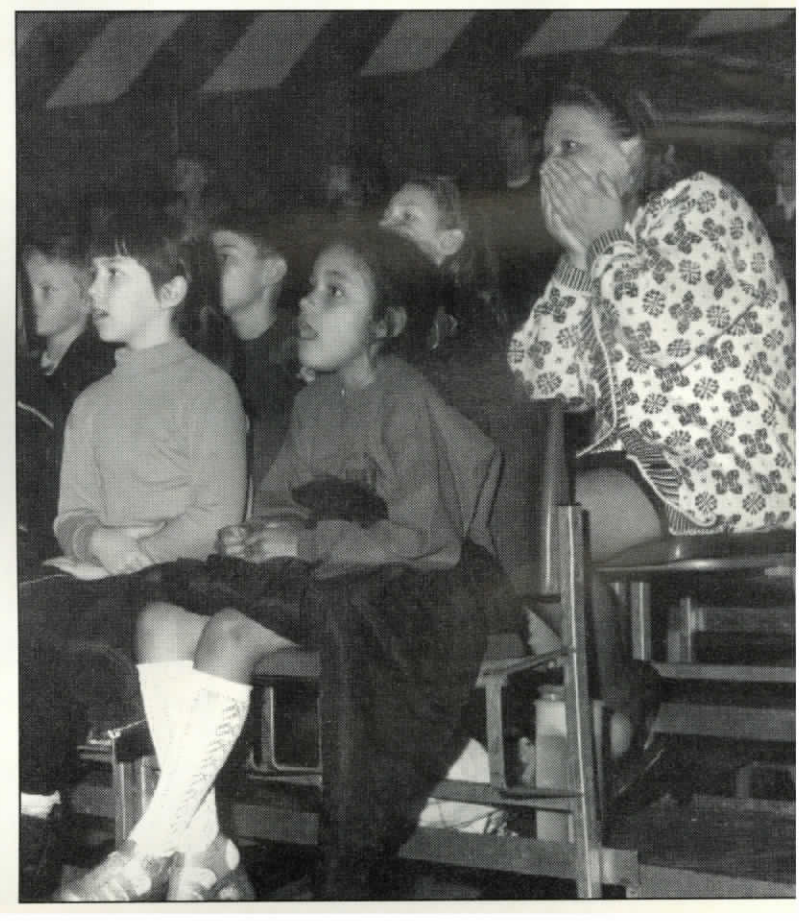
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KATHY GALLOWAY TAKES CHILDREN TO CHIPPERFIELDS CIRCUS





Angry unemployed fight Job Club cut in Thamesmead

PHOTO: THE KENTISH TIMES



Employees and members of the Thamesmead Job Club, at the Thamesmead Community College, Yarnton Way, are petitioning the government in a campaign to persuade the Department of Education and Employment to reverse the decision to close this valuable resource centre.

Members of the club, who are all local people unemployed for over six months, were only given four weeks notice that the club will be closing at the end of May.

"Our members are absolutely outraged. There is 25~c unemployment in Thamesmead and we desperately need this centre to get those people back to work," explained Job Club leader, Daphne Nicholls.

Computer Insight Ltd, the company who have held the contract to provide this service for the Employment Service since 1989, is being axed as part of a "re-rationalization" programme by the Department of Education and Employment. The department justifies its decision by saying that unemployment has fallen and therefore there is no need to spend money on unnecessary facilities.

Job Clubbers at Thamesmead will be offered places at either Erith or Woolwich clubs, with all travel funds reimbursed. However, Woolwich is losing one of three Job Club facilities while Erith only run one. Campaigners say that in the long run it will lead to longer waiting for people who are already at least 6 months unemployed before being eligible to join a job club.

Statistics show that in 1995 unemployment in the London Borough of Greenwich was 4232 and in this years has gone down to 3984. Campaigners, including the MP for Woolwich, John Austin-Walker, say that although these statistics point to a fall in unemployment it does not warrant the closure of this Job Club.

Robert Couldridge, of Maran Way, Thamesmead, was made redundant ten months ago after 21 years as a bank clerk has only been at the Job Club for three weeks. He says~ m very upset about the club closing. The advisor have been immensely helpful, but what really annoys me is that companies who already have my CV on file might call me for an interview when I've gone to Erith Job Club. How are they going to get in contact with me -I can't afford a phone at home."

In a letter to Mr. Austin-Walker, the Director of Finance and Planning for the Employment Service, Robert Horne, said the decision to close Thamesmead was made to ensure an even distribution of available provisions and took into account criteria such as the number of people unemployed in the area, the cost of providing the facilities and the success rates in helping people to find jobs.

Members of the Job Club feel that it is a sad irony that when they look around the room at the Thamesmead Community College they see encouraging posters, one of which says "JOB CLUB WORKS".

SPONSORED DOG WALK

The dog walk organised by the Jubilee Over 50's was a great success: the sun shone the dogs turned up with their owners and over £500 was raised for social events and Rene Howe says a big thank you to everyone who took part.

Some of the dogs who turned up with their owners for the sponsored walk are pictured on the right



PORTABLE KIDNEY MACHINE APPEAL

With Spring now upon us and thoughts turning to summer holidays, The British Kidney Patient Association ask readers to please stop and spare a thought for young kidney patients who, because they must stay attached to their large cumbersome dialysis machines for 12 hours every day, week in week out, have no chance of a holiday. The parents and families of these children are as surely tied to that machine as the young patients are themselves.

The Association is aiming to provide an APD portable dialysis machine for each of the 14 paediatric renal units throughout the country so that these young patients, and those who love and care for them, may get a much needed break this summer.

You can help by sending us your used postage stamps, trading stamps, petrol vouchers, cigarette coupons, airmiles, foreign coins and a little money (if you can spare it).

Contact Lynne Curtis, Appeals Secretary, The British Kidney Patient Association, Bordon, Hants, GU35 9JZ. 01420 472021/2.

Seconds OUT!

Local Hero Opens Shop

The British Flyweight Champion, Welling man Mickey Cantwell, traded in his boxing gloves for fishing equipment when he officially opened the new Ron Summers Tackle Shop in Abbey Wood on April 27th.

Mickey cut the ribbon to declare the new premisis open and was proud to show off his well deserved Lonsdale Belt to members of the Thamesmead Town Angling Club who turned up to witness the grand opening.

New owners Ron and Vicky Summers were delighted to welcome the fishing fraternity to the new shop,which was formerly known as Abbey Wood Angling. The Summers are looking forward to providing the local community with both quality fishing tackle and first class service and advice. Ron Summers can be contacted on 0181 310 2750.



EXEMPTION DOG SHOW

SUNDAY 30TH JUNE 1996
SOUTHMERE PARK, THAMESMEAD
ENTRIES FROM II AM.
JUDGING STARTS 12 NOON
ENTRY FEE £1 PER CLASS

Good citizens test will be held throughout the afternoon–dogs do not need to be trained to competition standard. Certificates awarded to all well behaved dogs.

Demonstrations: come and see the Husky Team, the Bernese carting dogs and other displays. Do you own a problem dog? Obtain training tips from the experts - bring your dog with you!

Free treats for all dogs entered in the show.

Breed Classes (for pedigree dogs only)
Novelty Classes (Open to all dogs)
Obedience Classes
Refreshments
Stalls
and lots, lots more.

PLEASE PHONE THE ANIMAL WARDEN FOR FURTHER DETAILS.

0181 310 1500 EXT. 345

Survey of Resident satisfaction begins

Thamesmead is about to begin a major satisfaction survey of residents to whom it provides housing and heating services. This important survey will be starting in the next couple of weeks. The main aims of the survey are as follows;

- to find what our customers think of the services we provide;
- to identify any concerns that residents have about their homes and where they live;
- to identify how we can improve both our housing and heating services;
- to assess how far residents wish to be involved in decisions affecting their homes;
- to establish a baseline against which we can measure our performance as a landlord in years to come.

From 17 June for three or four weeks, interviewers from Market Reseach UK Ltd (MRUK) will be calling on a number of residents in all areas of Thamesmead and requesting a brief interview.

The interviews will be completly confidential and no imformation that you give to the interviewer will be passed to the Company or anyone else. The results of the interviews will be used for analysis only and individual residents will not be identified.

The interviewers from MRUK will all carry a photograph and identification as well as a letter from Thamesmead authorising them to ask you for an interview. They will leave this letter with you in case of any queries. Please ask to see identification BEFORE you let anyone into your home. If you have any concerns please telepone the Police or speak to the main office on 0181 310 1500.

Futher details of the Survey will be covered in the next issue of the Thamesmead Times.

YOU'VE TRIED THE REST NOW TRY THE BEST

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You can lose up to 2 stone in 10 weeks!
So come along and join us and eat yourself slim!

THAMESMEAD CLUBS

MONDAY 1 p.m.	TUESDAYS 7.30 p.m.	WEDNESDAYS 7 p.m.
Sheila Long	Carol Williams	Maureen Newton
St. Augustines Church	St Pauls Church,	Lime Row,
St. Augustines Road	Bentham Road	Thamesmead South
Lower Belvedere		
01322 556369	0181 303 1828	0181 304 0185

WE ARE THE LARGEST GROWING SLIMMING CLUB IN YOUR AREA . . .

DAY TRIP

There will be a day out to Hastings on Thursday June 27th for the over 50's, the cost is just £4.50 - if you are interested please call Rene on 0181 312 4761

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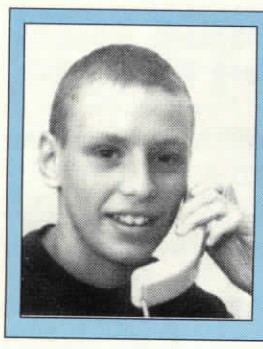
The above Venue is available for parties, functions meetings and groups.

The hall for hire can accomadite up to 70 people and is in Manor Close, off Crossway. For full details please David on 0181 311 9877.

Thamesmead

Planning for the Future

Harrow Manor Way,
Thamesmead South,
London SE2 9XH.
Tel: 0181-310 1500
Fax: 0181-310 1811



THE HARRIS REPORT

End of season round-up

CHARLTON ATHLETIC

It has been a year to remember for the 'Addicks'. At the time of writing, a play-off position is almost assured and the prospect of a gruelling two legged eliminator followed by a possible Wembley ~lnal lies ahead. Charlton's form has nose-dived of late and even though an automatic promotion place once looked on the cards, the season can still be classed as a complete success. Alan Curbishley and his team have achieved so much and are now recognised as one of the best sides in the first division.

The likes of Lee Bowyer, John Robinson and Shaun Newton have developed into top class players and the signings of Premiership regulars Matt Jackson and Bradley Allen have strengthened the squad. Add to that, excellent runs in both the Coca Cola Cup and FA Cup which resulted in victories against the likes of Wimbledon and Sheffield Wednesday and it is easy to recognise what a memorable season it has been.

Rest assured, a full account of the 'Addicks' progress in the play-offs will appear in next month's Thamesmead Times!

WELLING UTD

The 'Wings' have endured another hard fought relegation battle this season. However, it looks as though their place in non league's top flight is safe for another year. The loss of promising talent such as Steve Barnes and Steve Finnan to Birmingham couldn't have helped their cause, but I still find Welling's struggle at the foot of the table hard to understand. They have a good looking strike force in Dereck Brown and Oli Morah and have a solid defence led by club captain Wayne Brown. The team looks a well balanced unit, and although it has been another disappointing season overall, I predict better times ahead for Welling United.

ERITH & BELVEDERE

Managers at Erith have been and gone at an alarming rate this season, reflecting the disastrous year the 'Deres' have had. The future looks slightly brighter thanks to current manager Mick Ackland. He has introduced several new faces to the club and has picked up a win and a couple of draws over the last few weeks. Erith have only been saved from relegation by Braintree's withdrawal from the Beazer Southern league and had recorded only nine points by the start of April. Over 40 players have played for the club this season and next year should be one of consolidation, with the main aim of avoiding the drop.

THAMESMEAD TOWN

A mixed season for the Bayliss Avenue side, dominated by the unbelievable run in the FA Vase which saw them knock out the current holders and attract national publicity. 'Meads' cup exploits, which also included progress to the semi finals of the Kent Senior Trophy, has affected their league form. A mid table position should be achieved, and considering the team is almost unrecognisable to last year, most associated with the club will regard it as a pleasing season.

Bexley Annual Six a Side Football Competition 1996

Bexley's annual senior six a side football competition kicks off on June 10th and will run for 3 evenings a week for a 3 week period, culminating in the Finals Night on Thursday 27th June, (these dates have been arranged around the England fixtures in the European Cup).

The venue will once again be Erith Sports Centres, Avenue Road, Erith, with the full facilities of the Sports Centre available for players, supporters and families.

Newcomers to this popular competition will be made very welcome.

For further details and application forms contact Alan Bone, 32 Iris Crescent, Bexleyheath DA7 5QD, Tel: 0181 310 5018 or Leisure Link on 0181 303 7777 extension 3919.

Exciting new cricket Opportunities



Mike Gatting helps to launch the new Indoor Cricket Cup, an exciting new addition to the Heathrow Youth Games which involves over 13,000 young people from schools in 32 London Boroughs and the City of London.

HAWKSMOOR HERONS!



Hawksmoor Youth Club were presented with their new team strip by Ian Savill on Thursday 18th April - the Thamesmead Heron T shirts! The team had been trying hard to raise funds but unfortunately had been unsuccessful so Ian stepped in and was delighted to give the boys their first boost.

Thamesmead and the Thamesmead Times wishes Hawksmoor lots of success and looks forward to gefflng regular reports on their games.

Seen in the picture are Peter Joseph, Paul Grant, Paul Williams, Neil Boone, John McCarthy, Daniel Dunsford, Luke Kelly and Daniel McGuire.

Anglers reel in cash for Macmillan nurses

WHEN THE NATIONAL FEDERATION OF ANGLERS decided to "adopt" the Cancer Relief Macmillan Fund as their charity this year they knew their members were a generous lot and it has not taken very long to prove it.

The year began at the Angling 96 Exhibition in Birmingham, and there, and at the NFA's annual conference in Bridlington a week later, they raised £2,100.

"A remarkable sum in just seven days, but this is only the start", said Federation President Ken Ball

Jenny Edwards, campaign manager for Macmillan, who had a hectic weekend at a stand at Bridlington, went home with a lot of respect for anglers. "I just cannot believe it," she said. "The delegates were superb. We could not have dreamed of a better start to the campaign than to collect over £2000 in one week.

"I have never met anglers before, but I love them all!"

Quite a proportion of the money was raised by a raffle at the dinner dance which brought the conference weekend to a close. It was run with his customary skill and enthusiasm by Vice President Dick Derrington, his wife Carol and Chnstine Steade.

The week before it was NEC man Alan Bates and Misk Tu:ner, and their wives who got it going. There will be fimd-raising events at all the National Championships this year, and at other major events.

Lots of member clubs have also signified their intention to run events for the nurses, but the more the merrier. Anyone wishing to take part should contact NFA HQ, Halliday House, Egginton Junction, Derbyshire, DE65 6GU for information, or phone 01283 734735.

Crossways under 10's find multi billion pound funding



Wurth UK Ltd, part of the multinational Wurth Group turning over more than £2 billion per annum, are now sponsoring Crossways under l0's football team. Crossways were a natural choice for Wurth as they are a successful local youth team currently standing third in the Bexley & District football league and are competing in various five-a-side competitions throughout the summer. Wurth is not only a strong local employer but one that believes in being young, dynamic and go getting.

In conjunction with this philosophy Wurth are the first company in the Bexley Borough to take part in both the Modern and European Apprenticeship schemes. This not only offers work experience in all departments whilst still attending college on a regular basis, but offers a number of different qualifications ranging from NVQ level 3 to an HND. In addition Wurth, like the Midland Bank, Mercedes Benz UK Ltd, Lufthansa, Vauxhall Motors also work in conjunction with the European Vocational College. Wurth's policy is to, where possible, employ all those that have successfully completed their course.

Although they realise that the current Crossway's team is a little too young to join, they hope that one day these young hopefuls may join the Wurth team. In fact Wurth are currently looking for intelligent, well qualified, highly motivated 16-19 year olds to join the aforementioned training schemes. If you are interested contact Jan Hughes on 0181-319 6418.

Calling all Martial Artists!!

The Plumstead Sports Centre on Quilter Street, Plumstead is to be the venue for a whole day of martial arts events on Saturday 1st June between 10am and 4pm.

The event is being organised by Ron Cooper who runs the Jujitsu Club at the Alex McCleod School in Abbey Wood. Ron told the Thamesmead Times that he wanted to organise an event that involved all the local martial arts clubs and also to act as fund raiser for the Alex McCleod club which is in desperate need of new equipment.

The day event at the Sports Centre will include demonstrations of Goshin-Ryu Jujitsu, Kenpo Jujitsu, Judo, Muay-Thai boxing, Kendo and Karate and will be attended by well known local instructors including 8th Dan Tony Reay and Leon Jay, a 5th Dan in small circle jujitsu.

The whole day will cost £10.00 per person when paid in advance, or £12.50 on the day. The price includes refreshments and lunch and a licensed bar is available after the event. For further details contact Ron on 0180 312 4530.

GREENMEAD UII'S

This local derby between Thamesmead and Greenmead resulted in a 0-0 draw but the match was a cracker! Both teams played some lovely football on a spacious, level pitch which made the game all the more enjoyable to watch. The Finches had over a dozen chances to take all the league points, but wasted chances and some good work from the home goalkeeper kept the score level. Thamesmead controlled the first ten minutes of the match but from then on it was completely one-way traffic. Unfortunately for Greenmead, no chances were taken and they had to settle for one away point.

Darryl Kinsville won the Europa Man of the Match Award.

We are looking to add to our squad with defenders, midfield and a striker. Call Wayne on 0181-311-3777 for details about a four week trial.

FISHING IN MID-KENT

MAIDSTONE VICTORY ANGLING & MEDWAY PRESERVATION SOCIETY

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AEROBICS AND KEEP-FIT SESSIONS HELD LOCALLY

New step Class!
Commences Monday 10th June
at the Thamesmead School of Dance and Fitness. Disraeli Close, Thamesmead.
8.30pm-9.30pm Admission £3.00

Tuesday 7pm to 8pm
St Michaels Church Hall,
Abbey Road.Admission £2.50

Thursdays 7.30pm-8.30pm
the Church of the Cross Hall,
Lensbury Way, Thamesmead
Admission £2.50

Qualified RSA instructor
All levels of fitness welcomed.
For further information telephone:
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0181 312 0993

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